Think-Aloud Testing

A way to learn from people as they narrate their experience while performing a task

When people articulate unspoken thoughts, it helps you find the success and failure points in a design, and diagnose the causes. Think-Aloud Tests reveal important insights and inferences that would otherwise be unknown to a team. Just six to nine of these tests typically reveal 80% of the issues with a design, so it is a low-investment way to make a significant impact on the efficiency, effectiveness, and satisfaction of a potential solution.

Benefits

Reveals what people are thinking
Deepens your empathy for others
Uncovers opportunities for improvement
Lowers development costs through early discovery

Learn more at LUMA Workplace

Looking
Evaluative Research

LUMA System™

Focus of testing session

Evaluate how users understand, trust, and use **automated feature engineering outputs** when **domain context is missing** , and how this affects model reliability and decision-making.

Moderator

Researcher / ML Product Designer / UX Facilitator

Note takers(s)

Data Science Intern

UX Research Assistant

Participant

- Data Scientist / ML Engineer
- Business Analyst (non-technical stakeholder)

Date

21-01-2026

Time

30–45 minutes

Greeting and intro questions

Briefly introduce the session and purpose

What is your role and experience with ML models?

Tasks

Review Generated Features

Select Features for Model Training

Evaluate Model Results

Wrap-up

How confident do you feel using this model in a real business scenario?

Notes

- Participant struggles to explain feature meanings
- Mentions lack of business alignment
- Expresses low confidence in predictions
- Uses trial-and-error approach repeatedly

Preparation

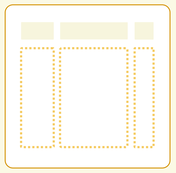
Identify what you will be testing and a few key tasks
Invite six to nine different people to be the participants
Schedule a testing session with each person

Helpful hints

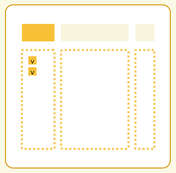
Defer any direct questions until the end of the test
Avoid the temptation to conduct a demonstration
Mimic functionality if the design is still in progress

See an example

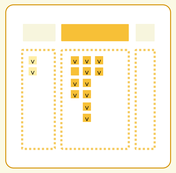
Activity step-by-step



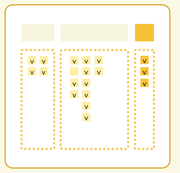
Introduce yourself and the purpose. Obtain consent to record.



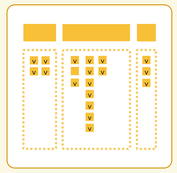
Ask participant to think out loud. Remind them: "We are NOT testing you."



Invite participant to do each task one at a time. Take notes. Or record.



Wrap up with your concluding question or remarks. Thank them.



If recorded: Listen and transcribe notes. Or upload transcript.